

UTEP talking to UA's Wing

Special to The Republic

EL PASO — University of Arizona assistant baseball coach Jim Wing may consider applying for the head baseball coaching job at the University of Texas-El Paso should it become open after the season.

While here for a three-game series Friday and Saturday, Wing discussed the job with UTEP Athletic Director Jim Bowden. It is believed that Andy Cohen, in his 16th year as the Miners' head coach, will retire after this season.

"I'd be interested," Wing said, "But there are a lot of factors involved. First of all, Andy hasn't announced his retirement, and I'd have to be sure that baseball would receive some priority."

"It's not that I'm unhappy at the University of Arizona. I have enjoyed my association with Jerry Kindall. But if you are in the game, you want to be head coach."

"Right now, though, I have just one thing in mind — helping the Wildcats win games the rest of the season."

Cohen has a 15-year record of 274-327. His Miners are 26-21 this season, tying the school record for most wins in a season.

Wing has been Kindall's assistant for six years. Previously he was the head coach at Tucson Palo Verde High School. His combined high school coaching record is 162-73. While at Palo Verde, he coached major league pitchers Andy Hassler (Kansas City) and Bob Lacey (Oakland).